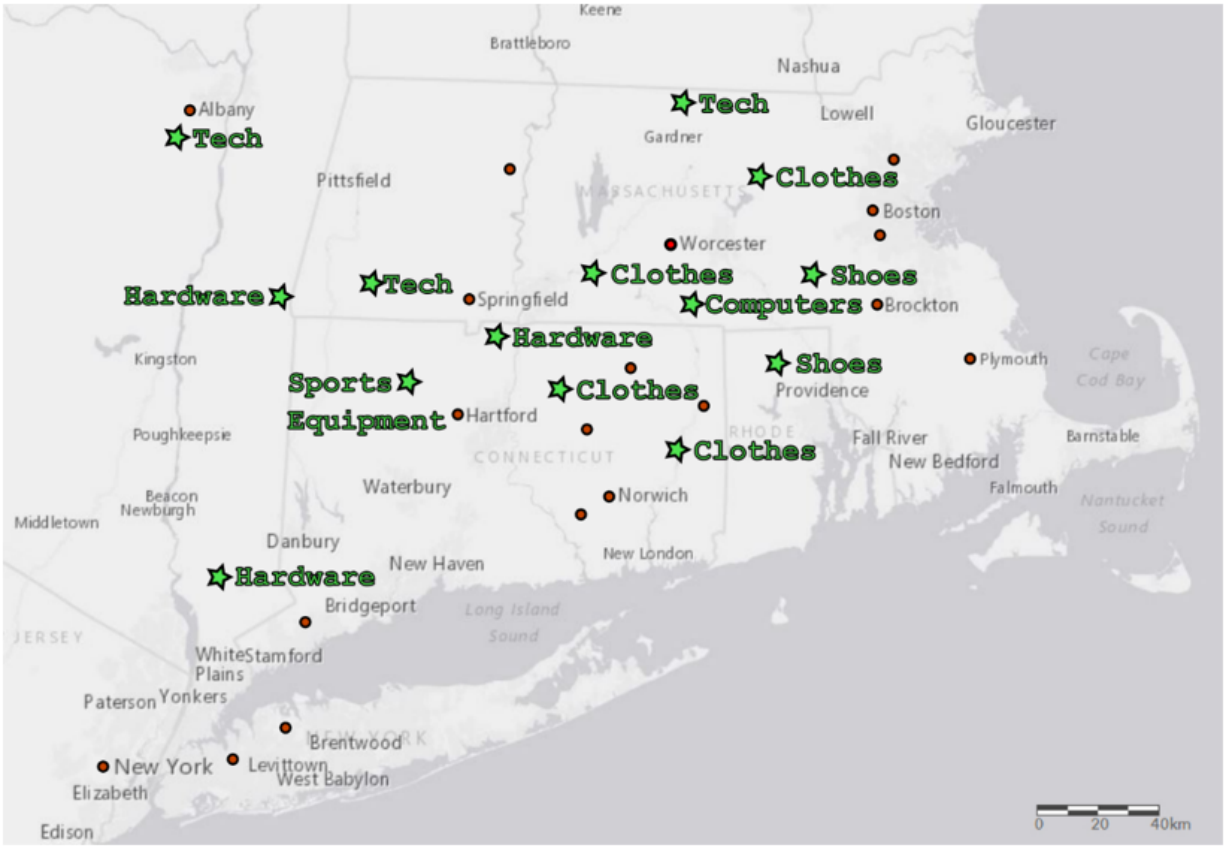


Figure 11.1 A map[1] with cities and hypothetical distribution centers (in this chapter we will often use retailer/shop as synonyms), and customers (red dots). For these shops, in the map we only indicate what they sell, for the sake of clarity, being that and not a brand the key point.

Given all the work done in the previous chapters, here we could actually get away with this chapter without even writing any code: either data structure can take care of all operations we need, just create a container (either k-d tree, s-tree, or another similar data structure) with the full list of warehouses, and then, for each customer's request, just query it to find the closest hub.